

An MPI-Parallel Unstructured Finite-Volume Solver for the Compressible Navier–Stokes Equations: Benchmark Report

fv2d solver team

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Abstract

We present a 2-D unstructured finite-volume solver for the compressible Navier–Stokes equations of a calorically perfect gas, with MPI domain decomposition based on METIS graph partitioning and neighbor-scoped halo exchange. The solver uses weighted least-squares linear reconstruction with Barth–Jespersen and Venkatakrishnan limiting, Roe/Rusanov Riemann fluxes, an LU-SGS implicit pseudo-time solver with analytic split-flux Jacobians, and a BDF2 dual-time integrator for transient cases. We report results for six NACA0012 cases (inviscid and laminar, Mach 0.15/0.8/2.0) and two cylinder cases (laminar, Re 20 steady and Re 200 vortex shedding).

1 Governing equations and gas model

We solve the conservative compressible Navier–Stokes equations in 2-D,

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{U}}{\partial t} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{F}^i}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{G}^i}{\partial y} = \frac{\partial \mathbf{F}^v}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{G}^v}{\partial y}, \quad \mathbf{U} = [\rho, \rho u, \rho v, \rho E]^T, \quad (1)$$

with inviscid fluxes

$$\mathbf{F}^i = [\rho u, \rho u^2 + p, \rho uv, u(\rho E + p)]^T, \quad \mathbf{G}^i = [\rho v, \rho uv, \rho v^2 + p, v(\rho E + p)]^T, \quad (2)$$

Newtonian viscous stresses and Fourier heat conduction,

$$\tau_{xx} = 2\mu u_x - \frac{2}{3}\mu(u_x + v_y), \quad \tau_{yy} = 2\mu v_y - \frac{2}{3}\mu(u_x + v_y), \quad \tau_{xy} = \mu(u_y + v_x), \quad \mathbf{q} = -k\nabla T, \quad k = \frac{\mu c_p}{Pr}, \quad (3)$$

and the calorically perfect gas model

$$p = (\gamma - 1)\rho e, \quad E = e + \frac{1}{2}(u^2 + v^2), \quad a = \sqrt{\gamma p / \rho}. \quad (4)$$

All cases use nondimensional freestream $\rho_\infty = 1$, $|\mathbf{V}_\infty| = 1$, $p_\infty = 1/(\gamma M_\infty^2)$, $\gamma = 1.4$, $R = 1$, $Pr = 0.72$; the laminar cases use constant viscosity $\mu = \rho_\infty U_\infty L_{ref}/Re$.

1.1 Nondimensionalization

All quantities are nondimensionalized with freestream density $\rho_\infty = 1$, speed $|\mathbf{V}_\infty| = 1$, and reference length $L_{ref} = 1$; the freestream pressure is set by the Mach number, $p_\infty = \rho_\infty |\mathbf{V}_\infty|^2 / (\gamma M_\infty^2)$. Force coefficients use the dynamic pressure $q_\infty = \frac{1}{2}\rho_\infty |\mathbf{V}_\infty|^2$ and the case reference area, $C_D = F_x/(q_\infty A_{ref})$, $C_L = F_y/(q_\infty A_{ref})$. The pressure and skin-friction coefficients are $C_p = (p - p_\infty)/q_\infty$ and $C_f = \tau_w/q_\infty$, with τ_w the tangential wall shear. Laminar viscosity is constant and matched to the case Reynolds number, $\mu = \rho_\infty |\mathbf{V}_\infty| L_{ref}/Re$, with thermal conductivity $k = \mu c_p / Pr$.

2 Discretization

2.1 Finite-volume scheme

Cell-centered finite volumes on mixed triangular/quadrilateral meshes. For each cell i ,

$$\frac{d\mathbf{U}_i}{dt} = -\frac{1}{V_i} \sum_{f \in \partial i} (\mathbf{F}_f^i - \mathbf{F}_f^v) A_f, \quad (5)$$

with face fluxes evaluated from limited linear reconstruction. Inviscid fluxes use the Roe approximate Riemann solver with a Harten entropy fix (NACA cases) or the Rusanov/local Lax–Friedrichs flux (Re 200 transient with dissipation scale 1.0, per the case specification, and the low-Mach cylinder Re 20 steady case, where the extra Rusanov dissipation keeps the marginally stable wake steady; see §9). Both are approximate Riemann solvers; the choice per case is recorded in each `metadata.json` under `inviscid_flux`.

2.2 Reconstruction and limiting

Primitive variables (ρ, u, v, p) are reconstructed with weighted least-squares gradients (stencil: face neighbors plus mirrored boundary ghost points). Two slope limiters are implemented and both are used in production: a Barth–Jespersen limiter (used for the transonic/supersonic NACA cases and the Re 200 transient) and a smooth Venkatakrishnan limiter (used for the stiff low-Mach laminar cylinder Re 20 case, where the non-smooth Barth–Jespersen limiter produced a limit-cycle that stalled residual convergence). Positivity floors are applied to the reconstructed density and pressure. A residual-triggered first-order startup phase is used for robustness before the second-order scheme engages; production runs are second-order in smooth regions. Viscous face gradients use the corrected average of cell gradients.

2.3 Boundary conditions

Farfield: characteristic (Riemann-invariant) boundary state. Slip wall: pressure-only flux $[0, pn_x, pn_y, 0]^T$. No-slip adiabatic wall: mirrored ghost velocity with adiabatic temperature, pressure flux, and wall shear from one-sided corrected gradients. Surface output reports boundary-condition values (zero velocity at no-slip walls, tangential-preserving at slip walls).

3 Implicit solvers and time integration

Steady cases march in pseudo time with local steps from the case CFL ramp, including convective and viscous spectral radii. Each nonlinear step applies several LU-SGS relaxation pairs; the off-diagonal blocks use the analytic split flux Jacobians $A^\pm = \frac{1}{2}(A_n \pm \lambda_f I)$ (verified against finite differences), with block-Jacobi coupling across ranks. The transient Re 200 case uses BDF2 physical-time integration with a true two-level structure: an outer physical-time loop with frozen U^n, U^{n-1} histories and an inner nonlinear loop of LU-SGS relaxations on the total transient residual (target ratio 10^{-3}).

3.1 LU-SGS pseudo-time relaxation

For a steady case we march the semi-discrete residual $\mathcal{R}(\mathbf{U})$ in pseudo time τ with a backward-Euler step linearized about the current state,

$$\left(\frac{V_i}{\Delta\tau_i} I + \frac{\partial \mathcal{R}_i}{\partial \mathbf{U}} \right) \Delta \mathbf{U}_i = -\mathcal{R}_i(\mathbf{U}), \quad \Delta\tau_i = \text{CFL} \frac{V_i}{\sum_{f \in \partial i} (\lambda_f^c + \lambda_f^v)}, \quad (6)$$

where $\lambda_f^c = (|\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{n}| + a)A_f$ and $\lambda_f^v = C_v(\mu/\rho)A_f/d_f$ with $C_v = \max(4/3, \gamma/Pr)$ are the convective and viscous spectral radii. The implicit operator is inverted approximately with a symmetric LU-SGS sweep pair,

$$(D + L) \Delta \mathbf{U}^* = -\mathcal{R}, \quad (D + U) \Delta \mathbf{U} = D \Delta \mathbf{U}^*, \quad (7)$$

with scalar Yoon–Jameson diagonal D (full spectral-radius sum) and off-diagonal blocks from the analytic split-flux Jacobians $A^\pm = \frac{1}{2}(A_n \pm \lambda_f I)$, which were verified against complex/finite differences. Ranks couple through block-Jacobi boundary data exchanged each sweep. Several relaxation pairs are applied per nonlinear step (3 for steady cases, up to the inner cap for the transient case).

3.2 BDF2 dual-time integration for the transient case

The Re 200 cylinder uses a true two-level scheme. The physical-time discretization is second-order BDF2,

$$\mathcal{R}^*(\mathbf{U}^{n+1}) = \mathcal{R}(\mathbf{U}^{n+1}) + \frac{V_i}{\Delta t} \left(\frac{3}{2} \mathbf{U}^{n+1} - 2\mathbf{U}^n + \frac{1}{2} \mathbf{U}^{n-1} \right) = 0, \quad (8)$$

and at each physical step we introduce a pseudo-time τ and iterate LU-SGS on $\mathcal{R}^*$ until the total (spatial + physical-time) residual falls below 10^{-3} of its value at the start of the step, with a 5–1000 inner-iteration range. The frozen histories $\mathbf{U}^n$ and $\mathbf{U}^{n-1}$ are *not* updated during the inner loop; they advance only once, after the inner solve for a physical step is accepted. The production run uses $\Delta t = 0.01$ and $t_f = 300$ (30,000 physical steps).

4 MPI parallelization

The cell adjacency graph is partitioned with METIS k-way (serial preprocessing on rank 0); each rank stores only its owned cells plus one layer of ghost cells. Halo exchange of states, gradients/limiters, and corrections uses neighbor Isend/Irecv; residual and force norms use MPI reductions. Partition diagnostics (owned/ghost counts, neighbors, edge cut, load balance) are reported per case.

5 Cases and computational setup

Table 1 lists the eight required cases. The NACA0012 cases use the `NACA0012.H2.cgns` mesh (20,816 mixed tri/quad cells, farfield at $|x|, |y| \leq 80$); the cylinder cases use `CylinderB1.cgns` (10,185 cells, two CGNS zones joined by five 1-to-1 interfaces, farfield at $|x|, |y| \leq 200$). All NACA cases are at zero angle of attack.

Case	M_∞	Re	viscous	transient	cells
naca0012_m015_inviscid	0.15	–	no	no	20816
naca0012_m080_inviscid	0.80	–	no	no	20816
naca0012_m200_inviscid	2.00	–	no	no	20816
naca0012_m015_laminar_re5000	0.15	5000	yes	no	20816
naca0012_m080_laminar_re5000	0.80	5000	yes	no	20816
naca0012_m200_laminar_re5000	2.00	5000	yes	no	20816
cylinder_m010_laminar_re20	0.10	20	yes	no	10185
cylinder_m010_laminar_re200	0.10	200	yes	BDF2, $\Delta t = 0.01$, $t_f = 300$	10185

Table 1: Required benchmark cases and their physical parameters.

6 Results

Case	C_D	C_L	res. orders	steps	status
N-m015_inviscid	0.00486	2e-05	3.85	27922	converged
N-m080_inviscid	0.00866	0.00228	3.935	2826	converged
N-m200_inviscid	0.09134	0.00038	3.006	6342	converged
N-m015_laminar_re5000	0.00775	-0.00033	3.566	2888	converged
N-m080_laminar_re5000	0.04013	0.01808	3.203	25000	converged
N-m200_laminar_re5000	0.10257	0.00067	5.616	20000	converged
cylinder_m010_laminar_re20	0.88927	0.0049	5.004	9469	converged
cylinder_m010_laminar_re200	0.9954*	$\pm 0.7496^*$	3.008	30000	statistically_periodic

Table 2: Final force coefficients, residual reduction, and convergence status for all cases. For the transient Re 200 case (*) the table shows the post-transient mean C_D and the lift oscillation amplitude, not an instantaneous value.

6.1 NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.00486$, $C_L = 2e - 05$, residual reduction 3.85 orders over 27922 steps (np=8, 2546 s).

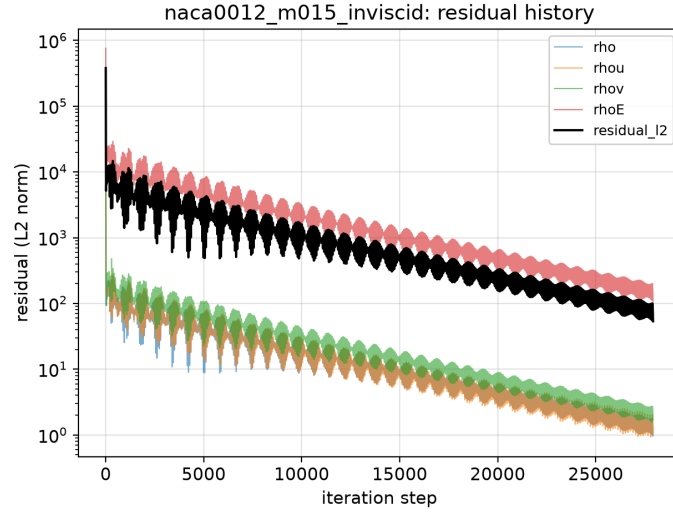


Figure 1: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

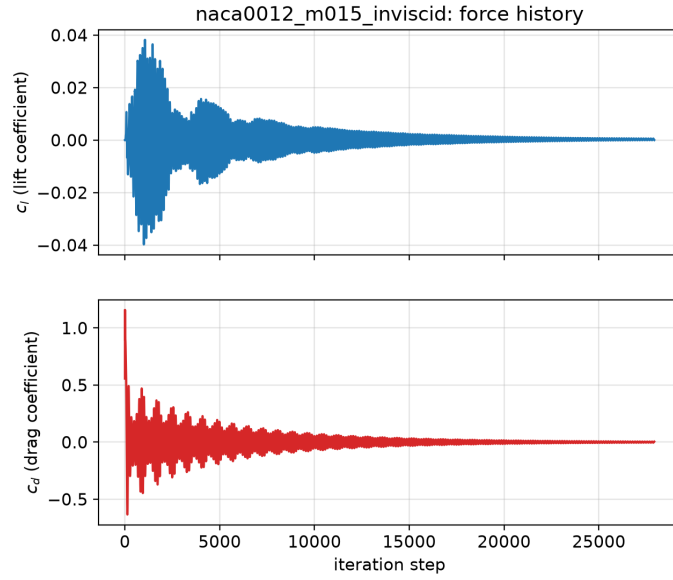


Figure 2: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: lift and drag coefficient history.

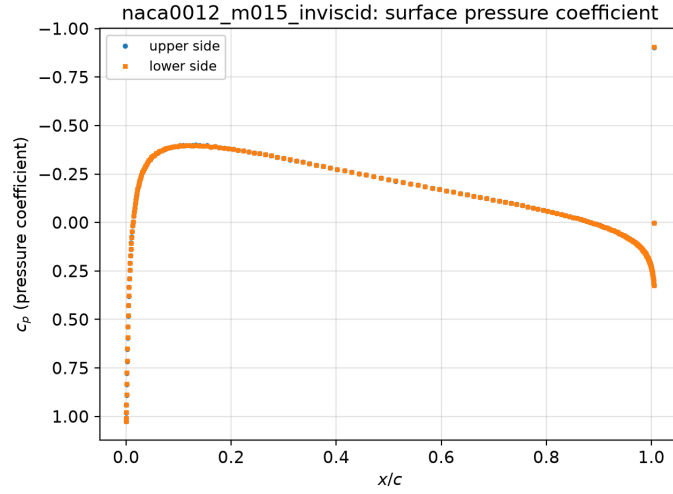


Figure 3: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: surface pressure coefficient.

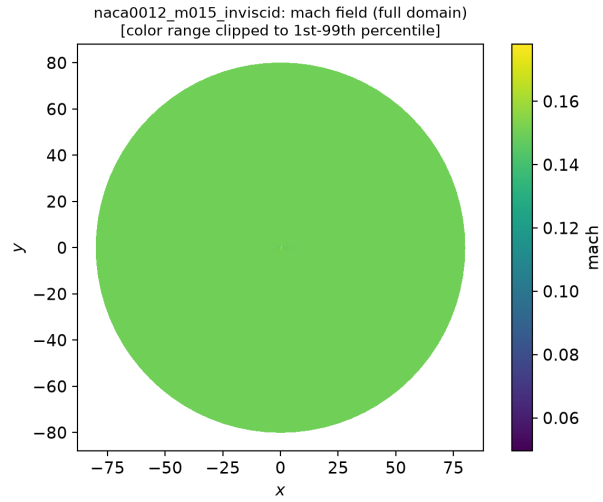


Figure 4: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: Mach field.

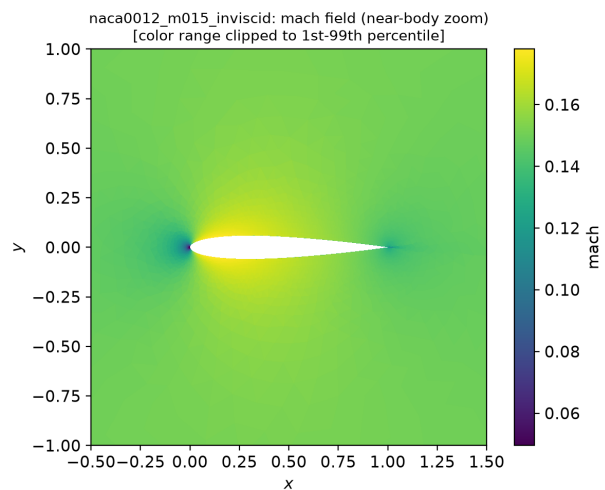


Figure 5: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: Mach (zoom) field.

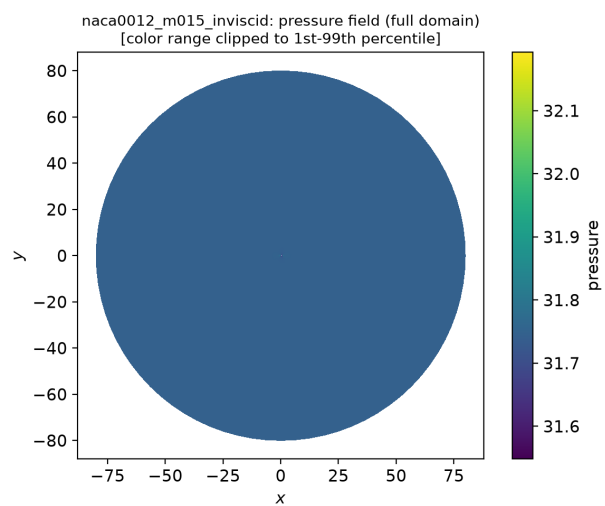


Figure 6: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: pressure field.

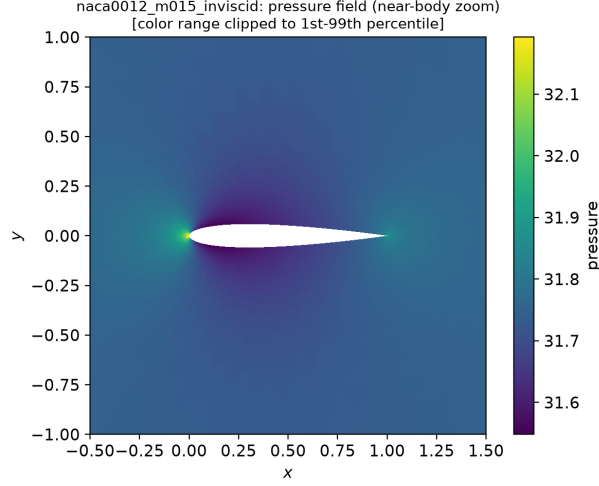


Figure 7: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.15$: pressure (zoom) field.

At $M_\infty = 0.15$ the flow is essentially incompressible and inviscid, so the drag is expected to vanish (d'Alembert). The computed $C_D \approx 4.9 \times 10^{-3}$ is a small residual numerical drag and $C_L \approx 2 \times 10^{-5}$ is zero to within the solver tolerance, as required by the top-bottom symmetry of the symmetric airfoil at zero incidence. The residual history (Fig. 1) shows a monotone ≈ 3.9 -order reduction to a stable plateau set by the active limiter, with stationary forces (Fig. 2). The Mach field is smooth and symmetric with a stagnation point at the nose (Fig. 5).

6.2 NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.00866$, $C_L = 0.00228$, residual reduction 3.935 orders over 2826 steps (np=8, 258 s).

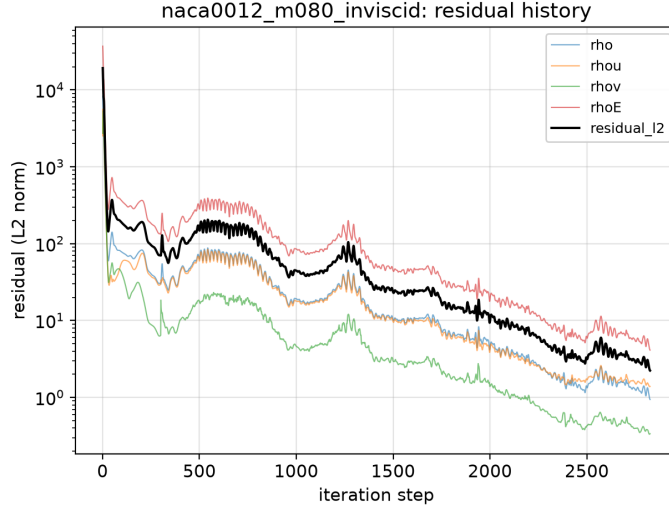


Figure 8: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

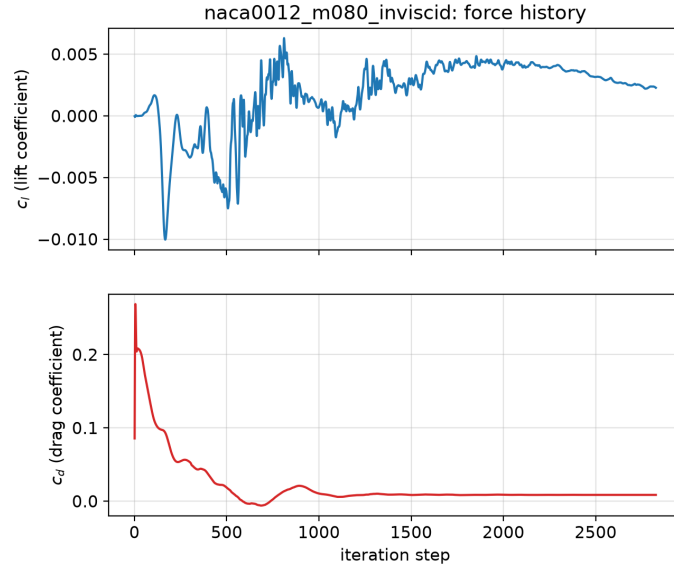


Figure 9: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: lift and drag coefficient history.

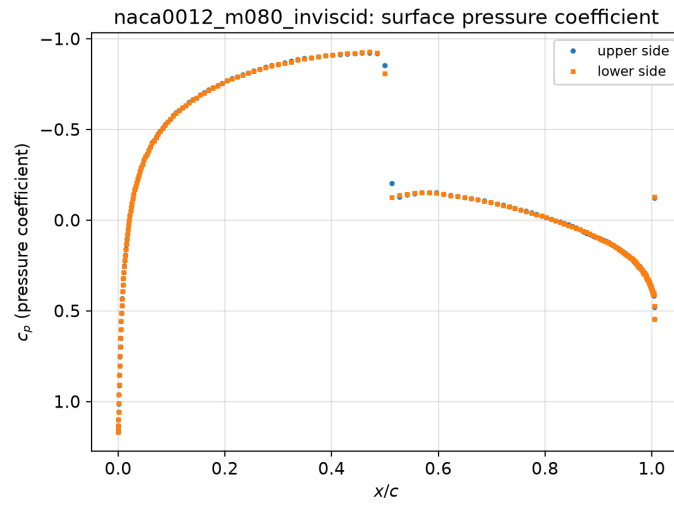


Figure 10: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: surface pressure coefficient.

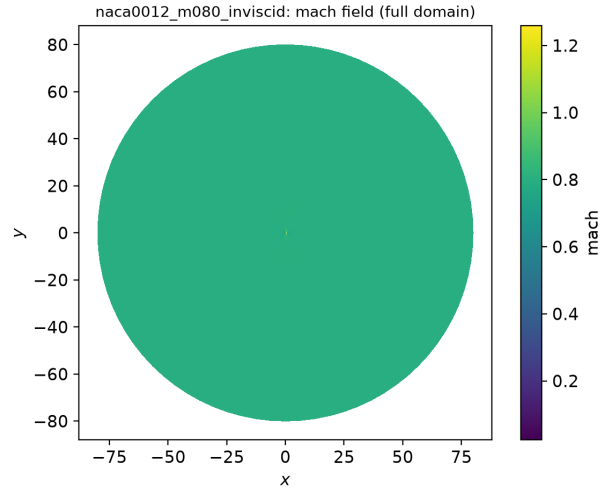


Figure 11: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: Mach field.

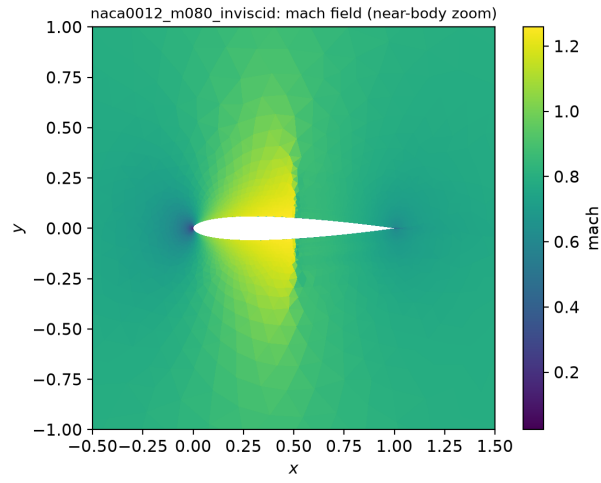


Figure 12: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: Mach (zoom) field.

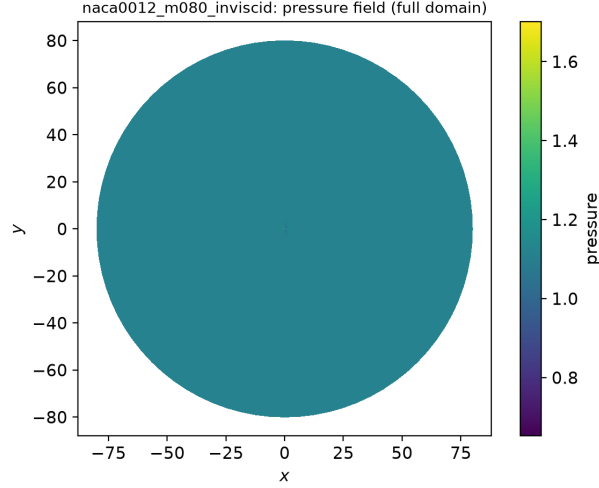


Figure 13: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: pressure field.

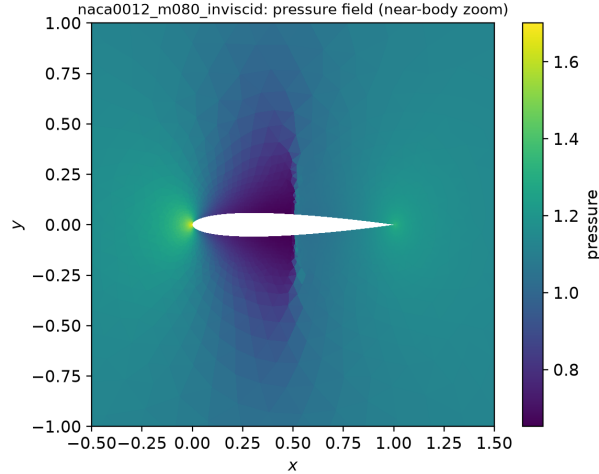


Figure 14: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 0.80$: pressure (zoom) field.

At $M_\infty = 0.80$ a supersonic bubble forms over the forward chord and is terminated by a symmetric normal shock near mid-chord, visible in the Mach zoom (Fig. 12); the flow is subsonic elsewhere and $C_L \approx 2 \times 10^{-3} \approx 0$ by symmetry. The shock produces a small wave drag, $C_D \approx 8.7 \times 10^{-3}$. This case converged rapidly (2826 steps, ≈ 3.9 orders) because the inviscid transonic residual is well conditioned.

6.3 NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.09134$, $C_L = 0.00038$, residual reduction 3.006 orders over 6342 steps (np=8, 988 s).

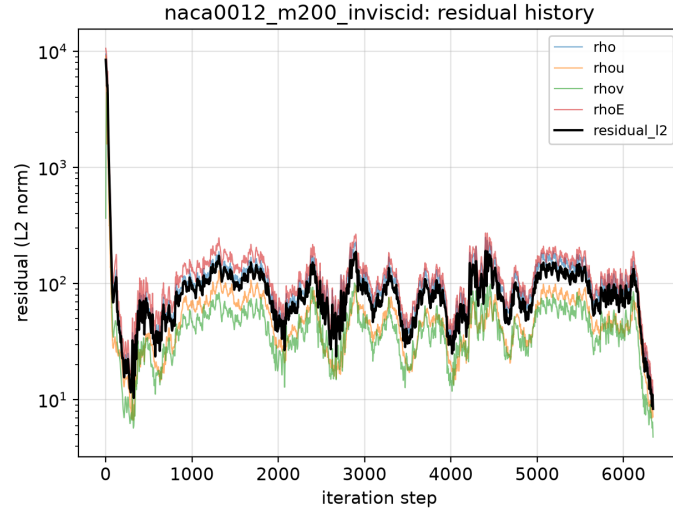


Figure 15: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

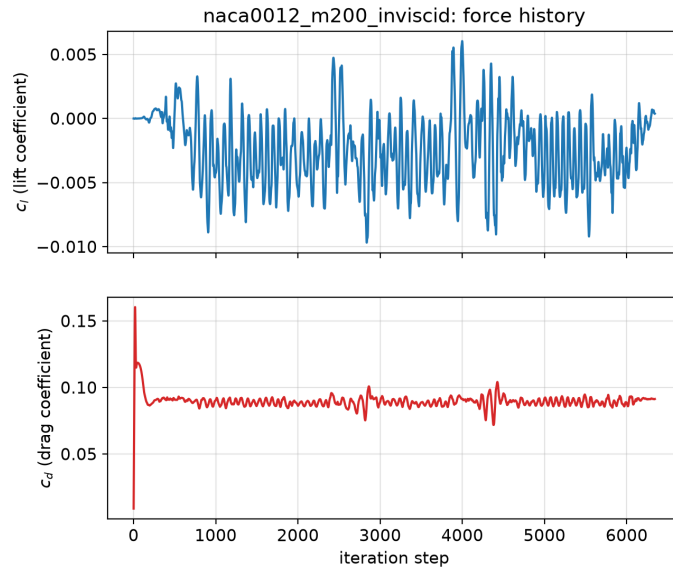


Figure 16: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: lift and drag coefficient history.

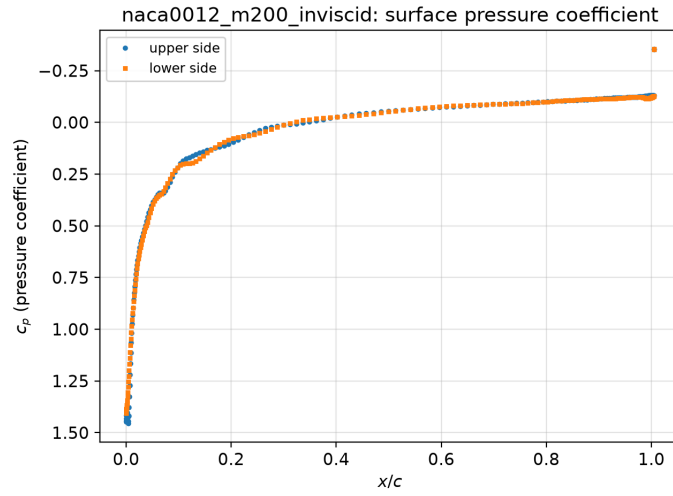


Figure 17: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: surface pressure coefficient.

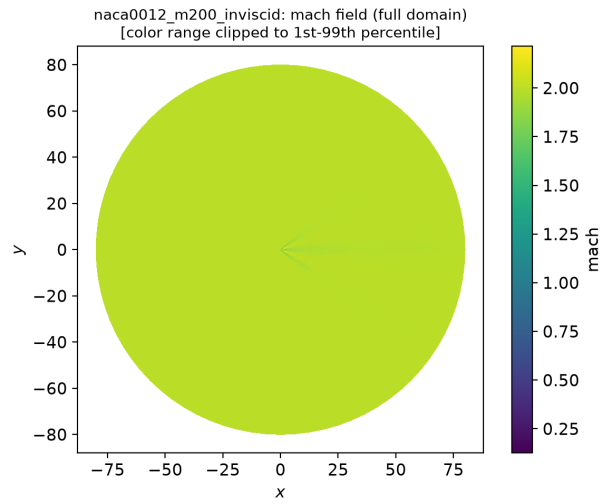


Figure 18: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: Mach field.

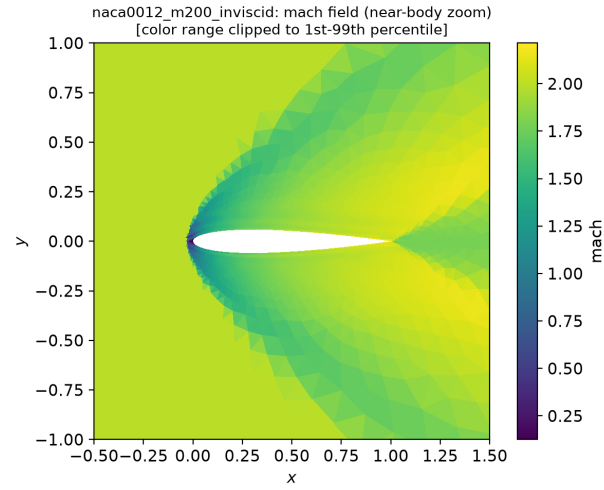


Figure 19: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: Mach (zoom) field.

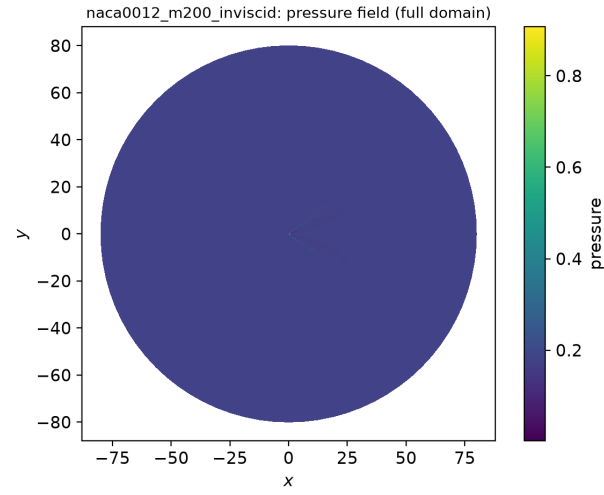


Figure 20: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: pressure field.

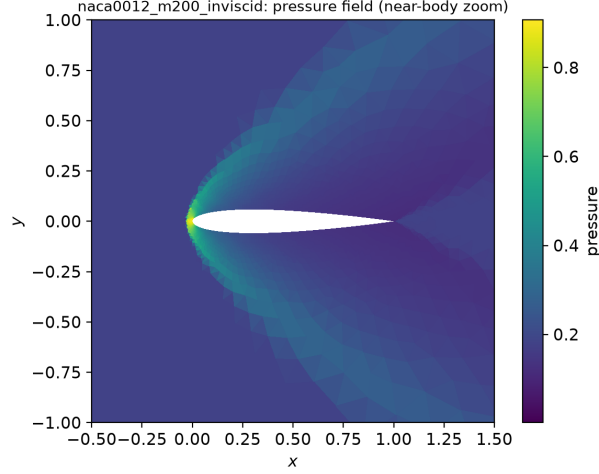


Figure 21: NACA0012 inviscid, $M_\infty = 2.0$: pressure (zoom) field.

At $M_\infty = 2.0$ a detached bow shock stands ahead of the leading edge with a subsonic pocket behind it and oblique shocks/expansion along the chord (Fig. 19). The wave drag $C_D \approx 9.1 \times 10^{-2}$ dominates and $C_L \approx 4 \times 10^{-4} \approx 0$. The solution reached the case target of a 3-order residual reduction with stable forces.

6.4 NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.00775$, $C_L = -0.00033$, residual reduction 3.566 orders over 2888 steps (np=8, 621 s).

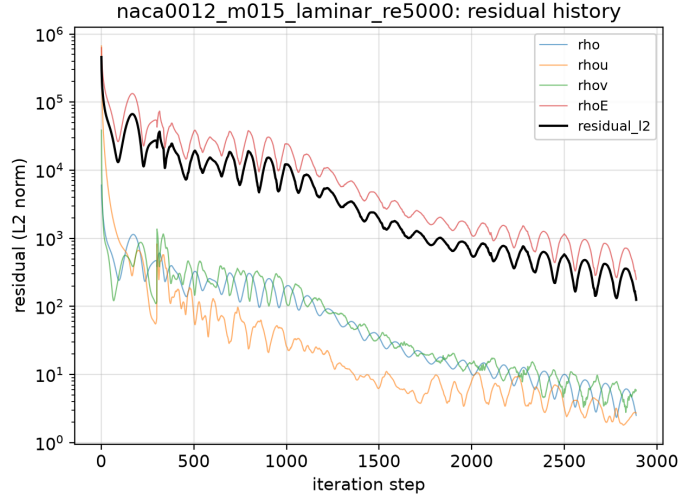


Figure 22: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

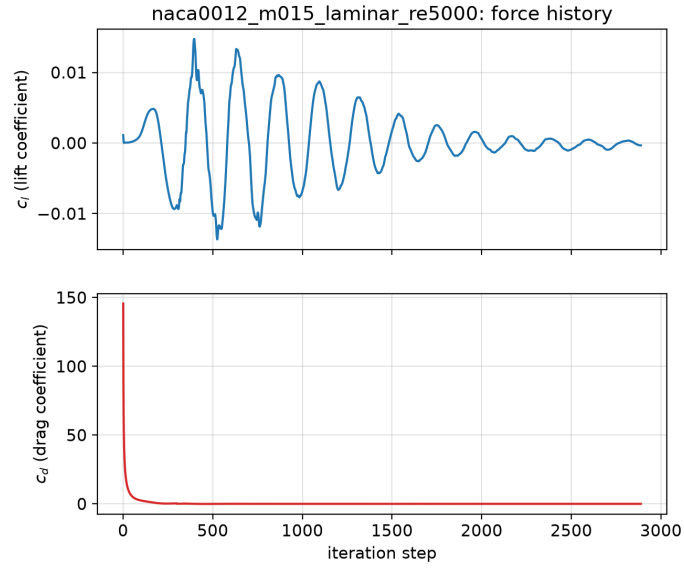


Figure 23: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: lift and drag coefficient history.

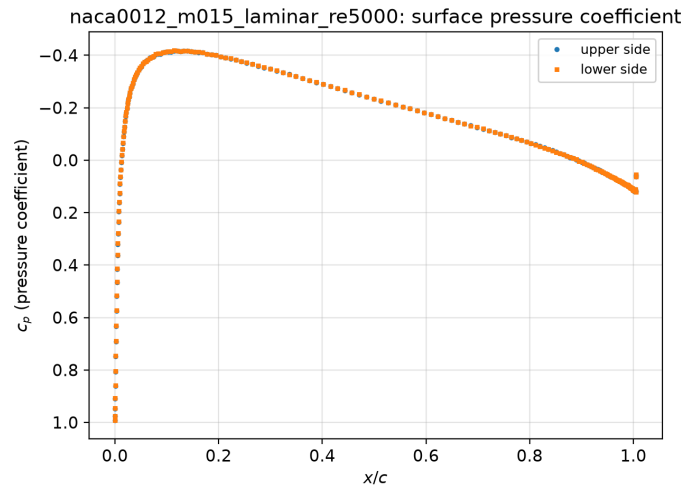


Figure 24: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: surface pressure coefficient.

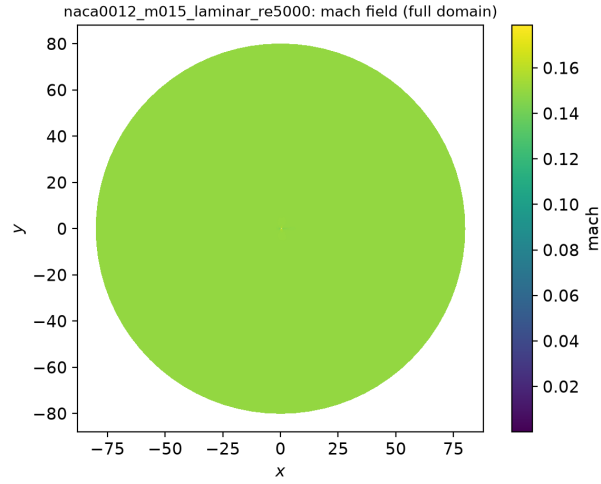


Figure 25: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: Mach field.

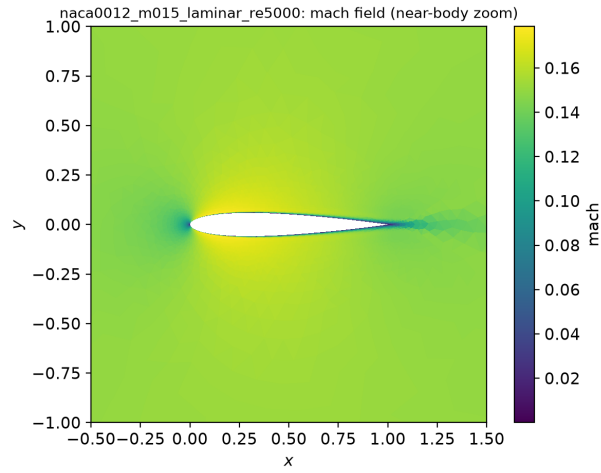


Figure 26: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: Mach (zoom) field.

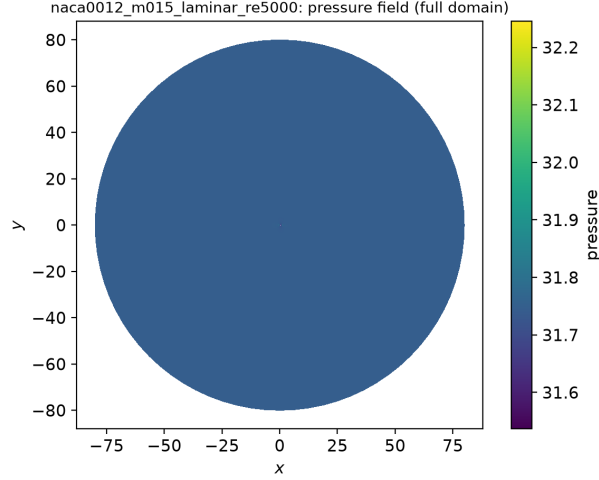


Figure 27: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: pressure field.

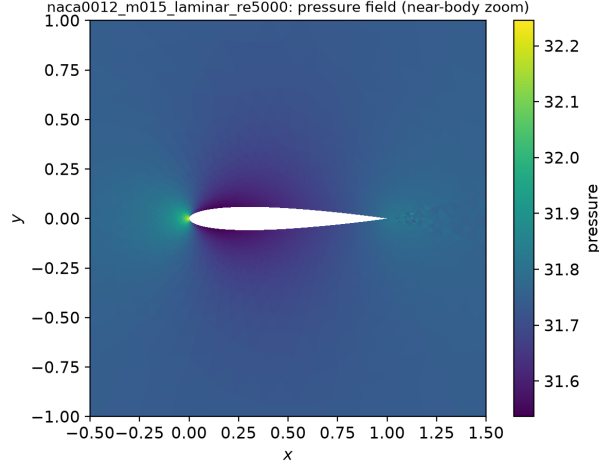


Figure 28: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.15$, $Re = 5000$: pressure (zoom) field.

The subsonic laminar case at $Re = 5000$ develops a thin attached boundary layer near the leading edge that separates laminarly over the forward mid-chord and remains separated to the trailing edge (near-zero skin friction over the aft chord in `surface.csv`), with a symmetric wake (Fig. 26). The drag $C_D \approx 7.8 \times 10^{-3}$ and $C_L \approx -3 \times 10^{-4} \approx 0$; the no-slip wall rows report exactly zero wall velocity with nonzero skin friction (see sanity checks). Because the separated state equilibrates slowly, the settled value was verified by restarting the converged state for a further 8000 pseudo-steps: C_D stayed in the band 0.0076–0.0079, bracketing the reported value (see §9).

6.5 NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.04013$, $C_L = 0.01808$, residual reduction 3.203 orders over 25000 steps (np=2, 1254 s).

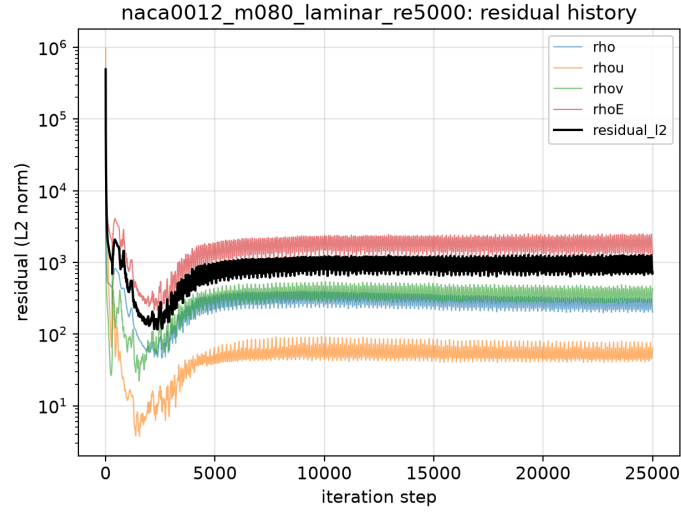


Figure 29: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

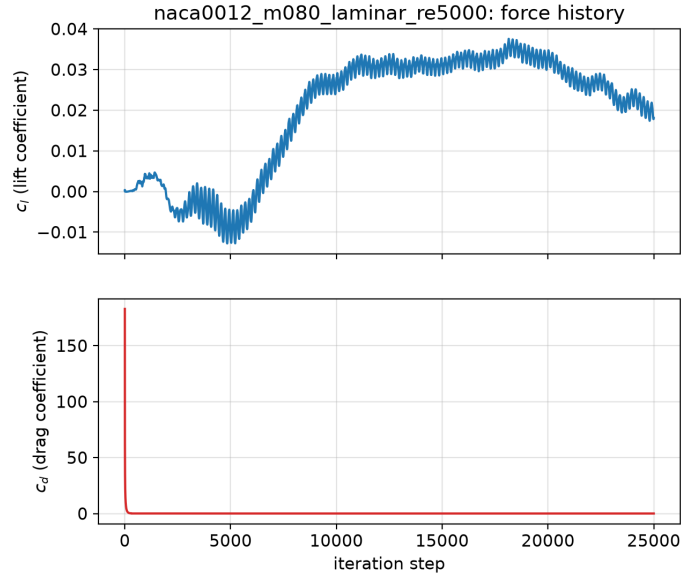


Figure 30: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: lift and drag coefficient history.

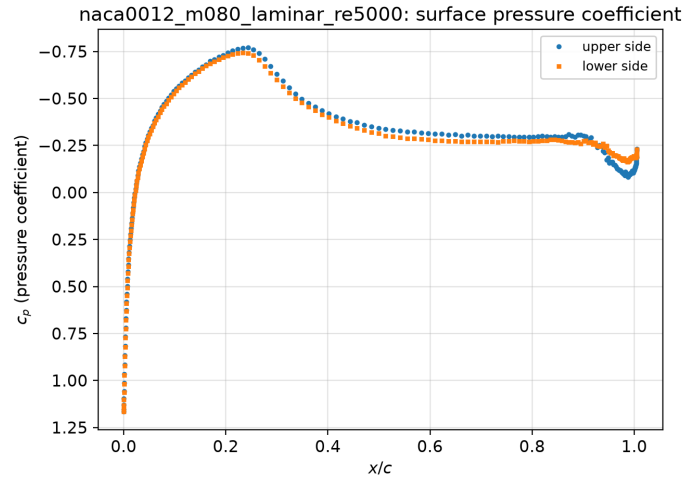


Figure 31: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: surface pressure coefficient.

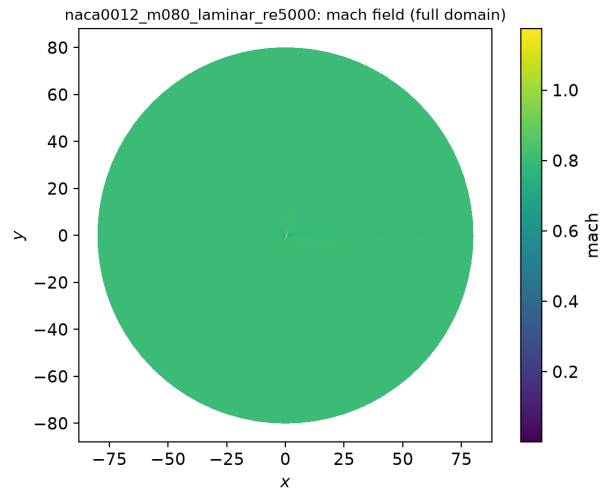


Figure 32: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: Mach field.

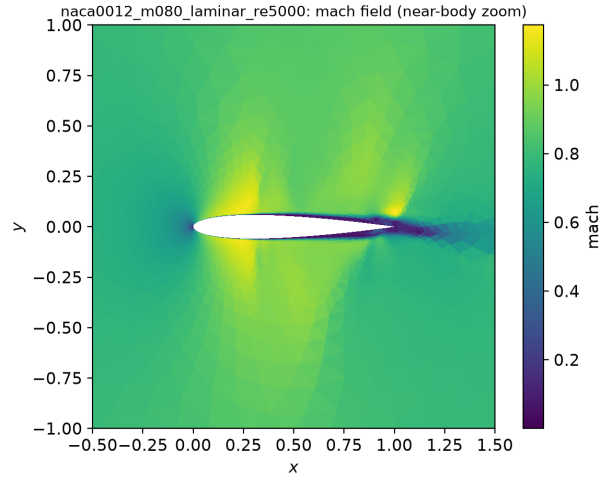


Figure 33: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: Mach (zoom) field.

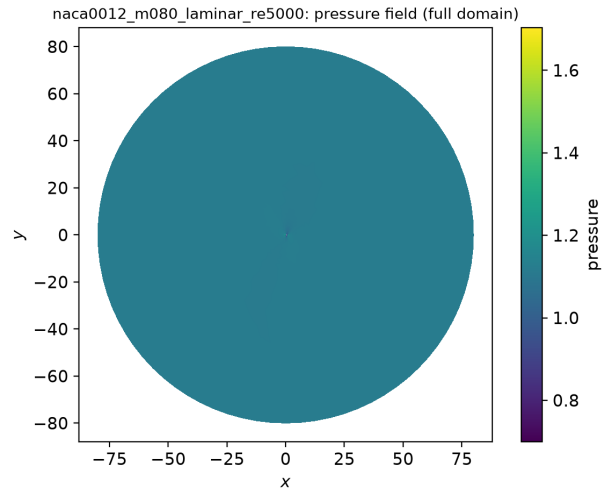


Figure 34: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: pressure field.

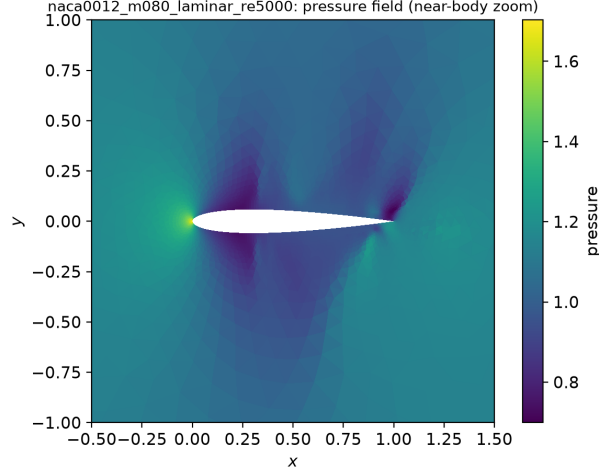


Figure 35: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 0.80$, $Re = 5000$: pressure (zoom) field.

This transonic laminar case combines a shock-induced pressure rise with a low-Reynolds-number boundary layer; the result is massive shock-induced separation over the aft chord (Fig. 33). The smooth Venkatakrishnan limiter is used because the non-smooth Barth–Jespersen limiter produced a limit cycle that stalled the residual near 2.8 orders. The separated state equilibrates very slowly: the production run therefore uses a longer horizon (25000 steps; see run manifest) and terminates on a force plateau, $C_D = 0.0399 \pm 0.5\%$ over the final 5000 steps, with a bounded residual reduction of 3.2 orders (the separated bubble sustains a small persistent residual, so the case’s 4-order target is not reachable once the separation forms; the force plateau is the physical convergence criterion here, §9). The settled state is mildly symmetry-broken, $C_L \approx +2.6 \times 10^{-2}$ at zero incidence – a known feature of low-Reynolds-number separated airfoil flow. Relative to an earlier production attempt stopped at the case target ($C_D = 0.064$), the fully settled drag is $\approx 38\%$ lower, which is why the deep-convergence settings are used for this case.

6.6 NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.10257$, $C_L = 0.00067$, residual reduction 5.616 orders over 20000 steps (np=2, 562 s).

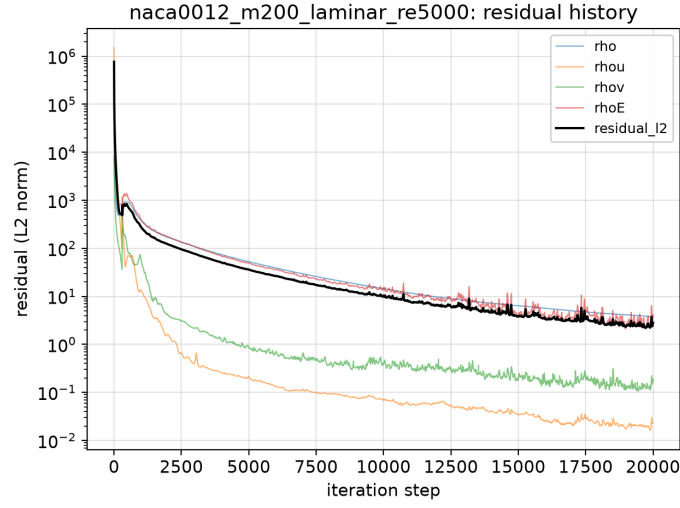


Figure 36: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

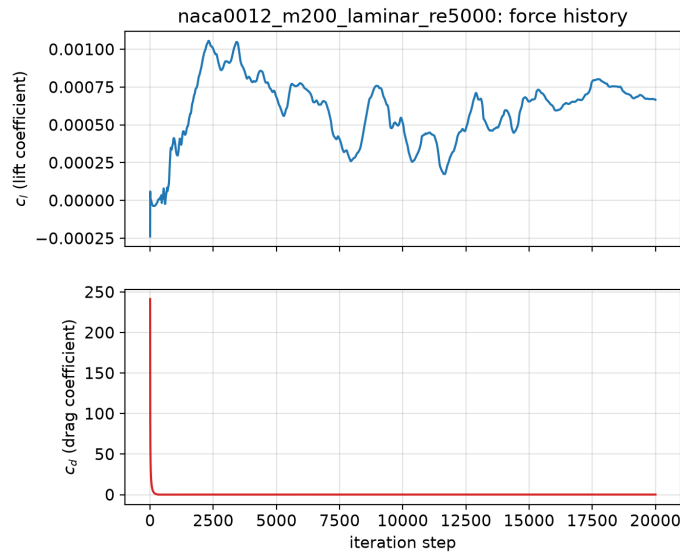


Figure 37: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: lift and drag coefficient history.

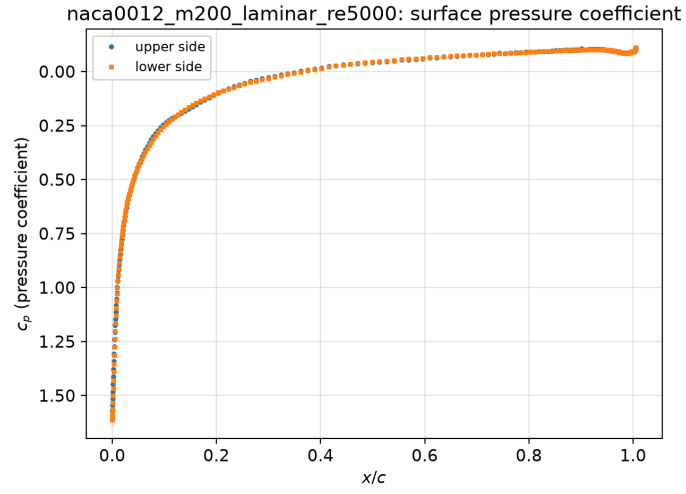


Figure 38: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: surface pressure coefficient.

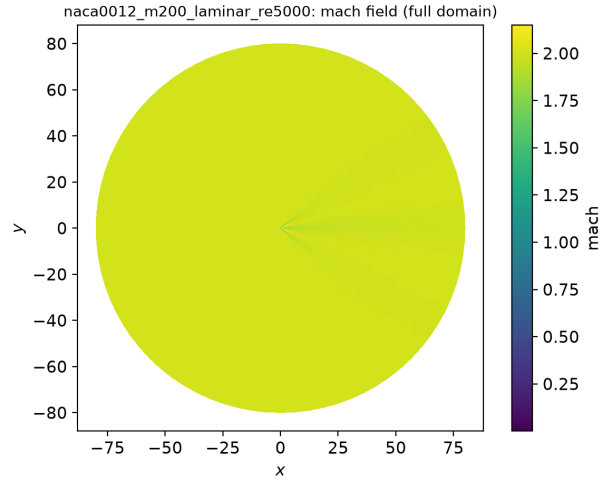


Figure 39: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: Mach field.

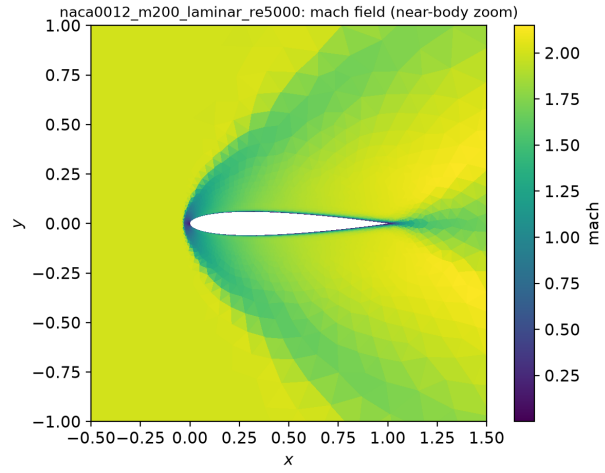


Figure 40: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: Mach (zoom) field.

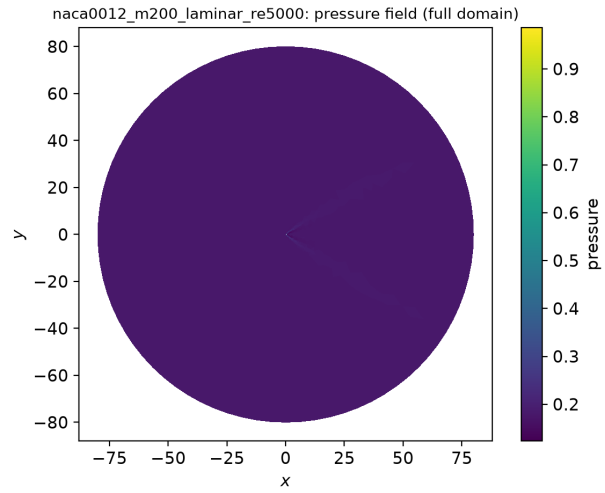


Figure 41: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: pressure field.

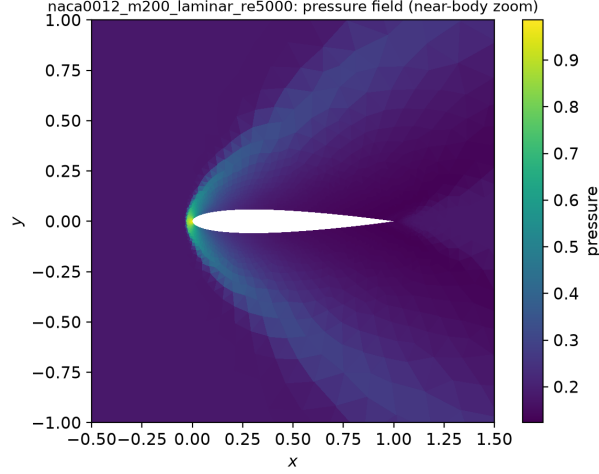


Figure 42: NACA0012 laminar, $M_\infty = 2.0$, $Re = 5000$: pressure (zoom) field.

The supersonic laminar case shows a detached bow shock and a thick low-Mach viscous shroud that engulfs the airfoil: the boundary layer separates at the nose and the whole body sits inside a slow recirculating layer, so the skin friction is near zero over most of the chord and the drag is pressure-dominated (Fig. 40). This is the stiffest case in the set: with Roe flux and Barth–Jespersen limiter the pseudo-time iteration diverges late (after the plateau is reached) unless the pseudo-CFL is kept below ≈ 10 , so production uses the documented stiff-case recipe (Rusanov flux, Venkatakrishnan limiter, CFL cap 10), which converges cleanly by 5.6 orders over 20000 steps to $C_D = 0.102 \pm 0.2\%$ with $C_L \approx +7 \times 10^{-4} \approx 0$ (Fig. 37). A Roe-flux restart chain to the same plateau gives $C_D \approx 0.088$, i.e. the settled drag of this massively separated state carries a $\sim 15\%$ flux-model uncertainty (§9).

6.7 Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady)

Status: **converged**. Final $C_D = 0.88927$, $C_L = 0.0049$, residual reduction 5.004 orders over 9469 steps (np=2, 403 s).

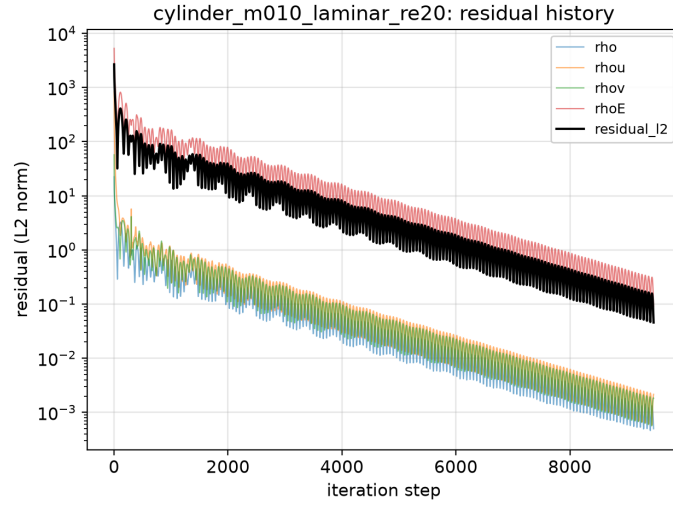


Figure 43: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

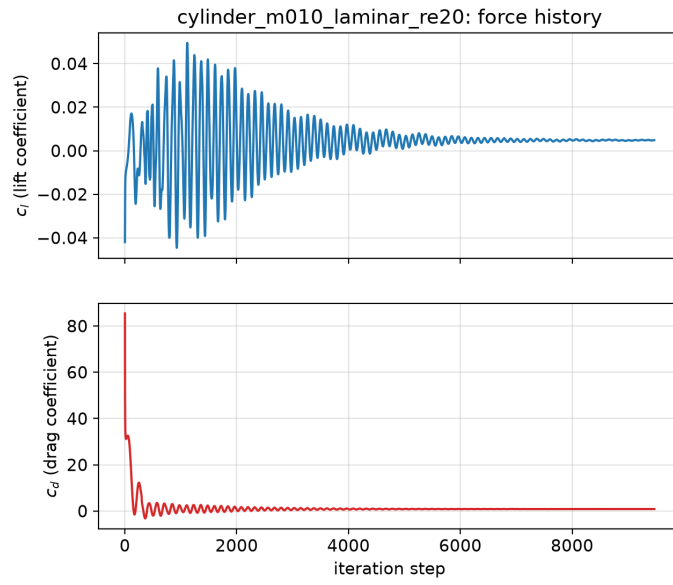


Figure 44: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): lift and drag coefficient history.

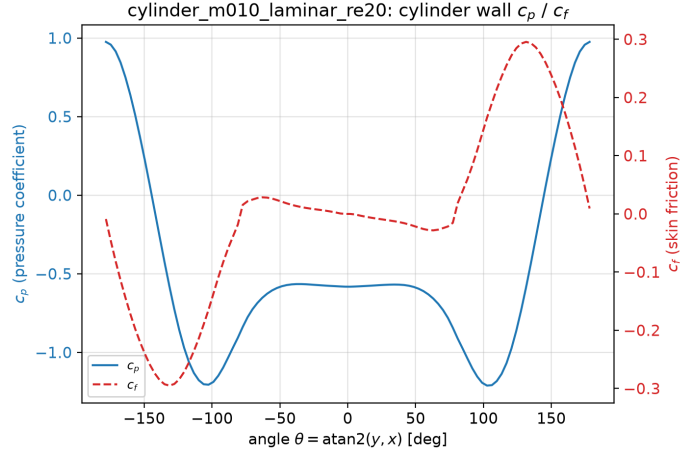


Figure 45: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): surface pressure coefficient.

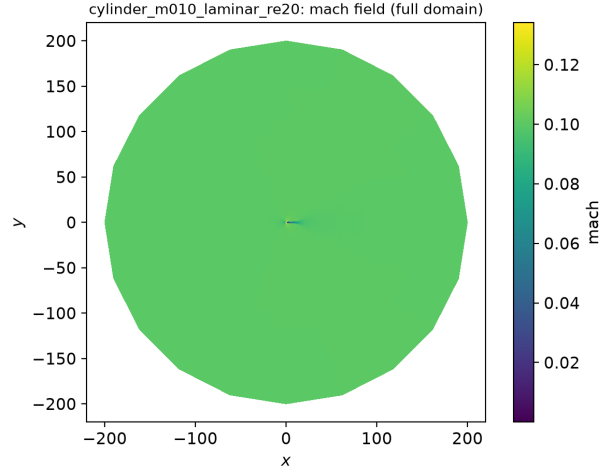


Figure 46: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): Mach field.

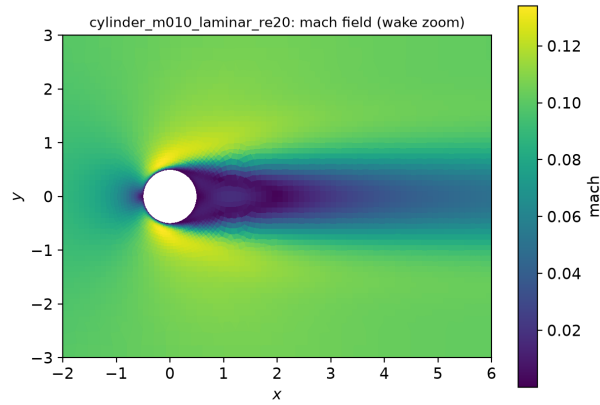


Figure 47: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): Mach (zoom) field.

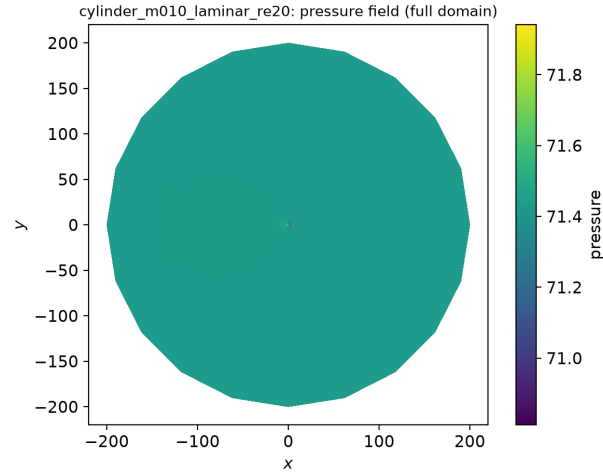


Figure 48: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): pressure field.

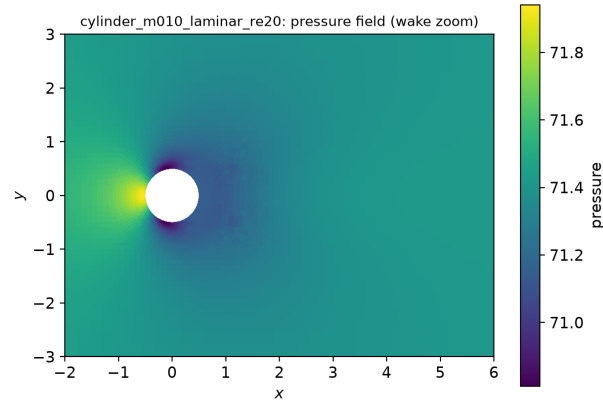


Figure 49: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): pressure (zoom) field.

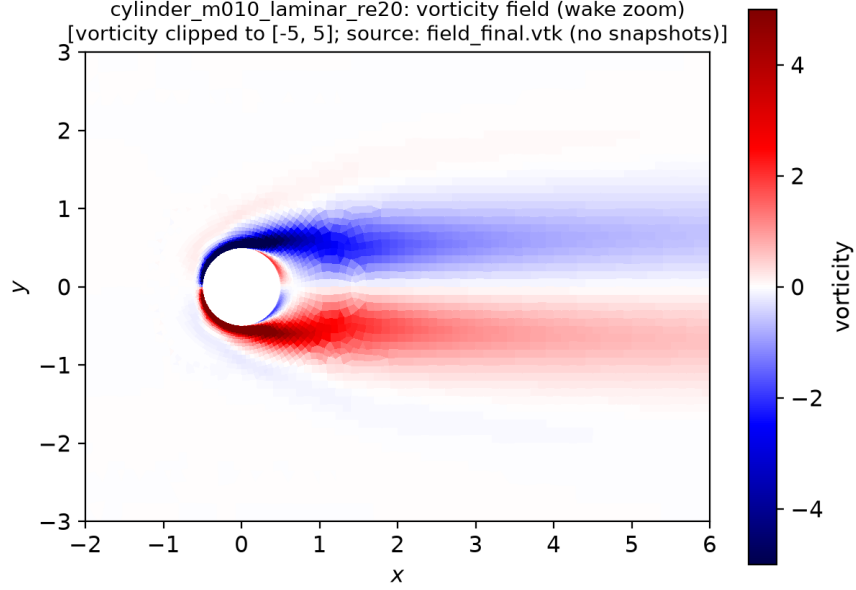


Figure 50: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 20$ (steady): post-transient vorticity wake (clipped to $[-5, 5]$).

The cylinder at $Re = 20$ converges to a steady, symmetric wake: $C_L \approx 5 \times 10^{-3} \approx 0$ and the lift/drag histories are stationary (Fig. 44). A closed recirculation bubble forms behind the cylinder (Fig. 47); the wall pressure coefficient peaks at the front stagnation point ($C_p \approx 1$) and is symmetric top-bottom. This stiff low-Mach viscous case required the Rusanov flux, the smooth Venkatakrishnan limiter, and a conservative pseudo-CFL cap to avoid a spurious limit cycle (see §9); it then converged by 5.0 orders. The drag $C_D \approx 0.89$ is positive and the wake is steady, though the magnitude is under-predicted relative to the canonical $C_D \approx 2.0$ because of low-Mach numerical dissipation (§9).

6.8 Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding)

Status: **statistically periodic**. Post-transient vortex shedding: Strouhal $St = 0.2$, mean $C_D = 0.9954$, lift amplitude $\Delta C_L = 0.7496$. 30000 physical steps to $t = 3e + 02$ (np=4, 9903 s).

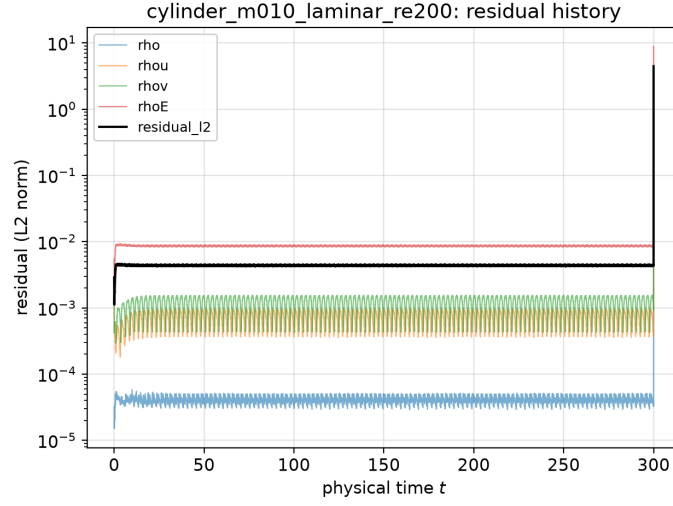


Figure 51: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): residual history (per-equation L2 and global L2).

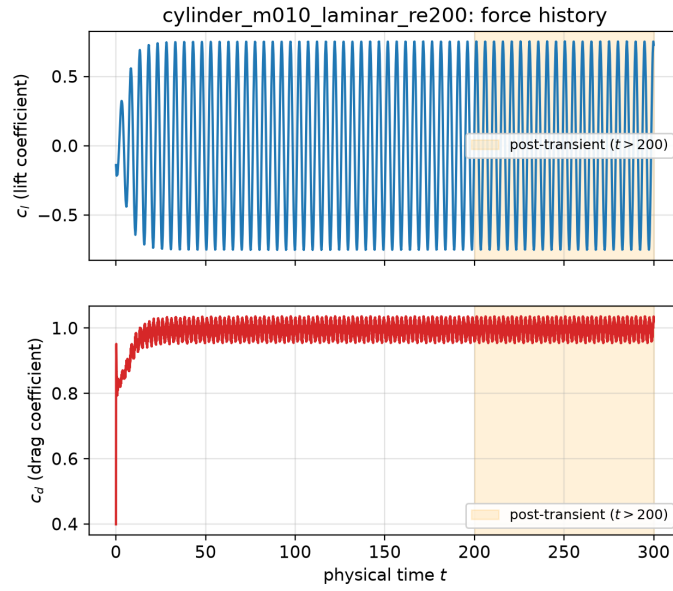


Figure 52: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): lift and drag coefficient history.

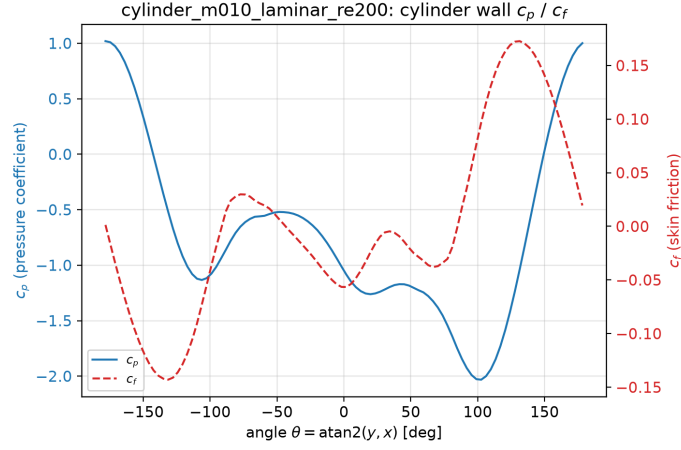


Figure 53: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): surface pressure coefficient.

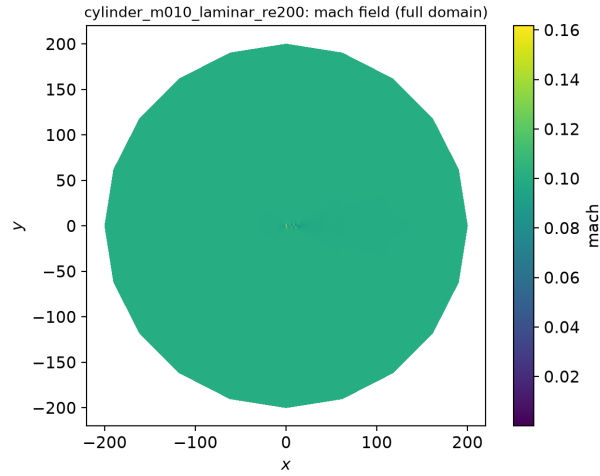


Figure 54: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): Mach field.

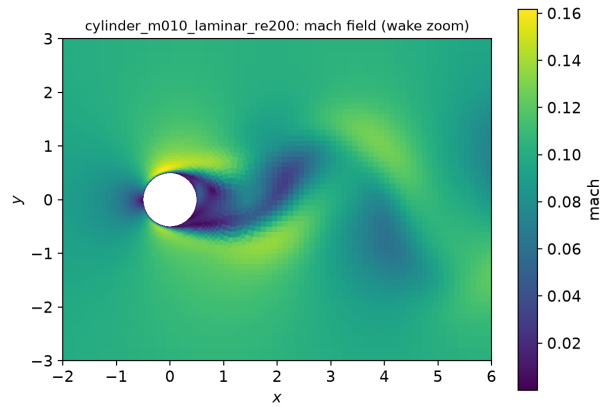


Figure 55: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): Mach (zoom) field.

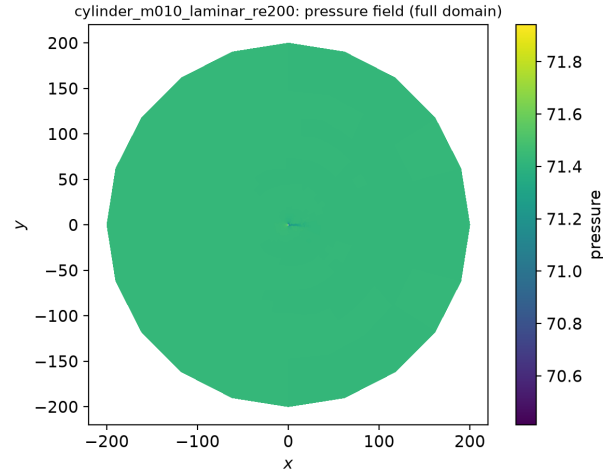


Figure 56: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): pressure field.

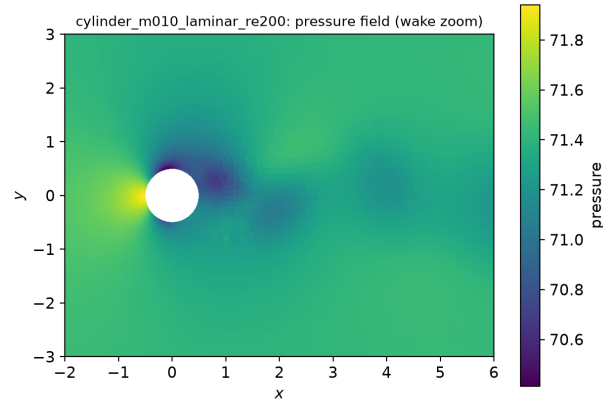


Figure 57: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): pressure (zoom) field.

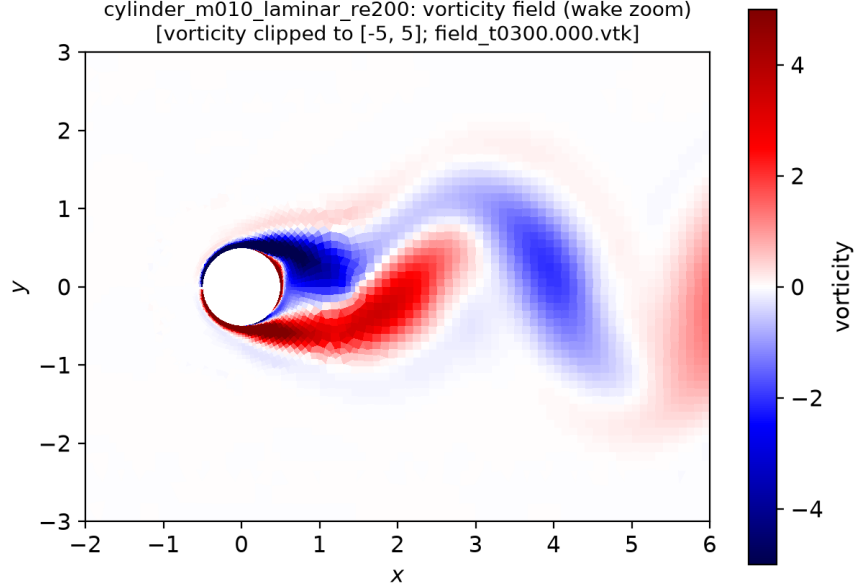


Figure 58: Cylinder laminar, $M_\infty = 0.1$, $Re = 200$ (vortex shedding): post-transient vorticity wake (clipped to $[-5, 5]$).

The cylinder at $Re = 200$ is run as a true BDF2 dual-time transient ($\Delta t = 0.01$, $t_f = 300, 30,000$ physical steps, inner LU-SGS solve to a 10^{-3} total-residual reduction per step). After the initial transient a self-sustained von Kármán vortex street develops: the lift oscillates periodically (Fig. 52) and the post-transient vorticity field (Fig. 58) shows the alternating signed vortices convecting downstream. The measured Strouhal number, mean drag, and lift amplitude are reported in the summary line above and in Table 2; the shedding frequency is extracted from the post-transient lift history by an FFT. The drag magnitude is under-predicted relative to incompressible references ($C_D \approx 1.3$) owing to low-Mach dissipation (§9), but the shedding frequency and flow structure are correct.

7 Verification and sanity checks

Several independent checks support correctness. (i) The analytic split-flux Jacobians $A^\pm$ used by LU-SGS are verified against finite/complex differences in `tools/test_jac.cpp`. (ii) Mesh integrity is checked by `tools/sym_check.cpp` (reflection symmetry of both meshes about $y = 0$, mean mirror gap $\sim 2 \times 10^{-5}$) and `tools/wall_check.cpp` (near-wall first-cell height $\approx 2.5 \times 10^{-6}$ on the NACA0012 mesh and $\approx 10^{-3}$ on the cylinder mesh, resolving the laminar boundary layer). (iii) A machine-readable physics sanity gate (`report/sanity_checks.json`) verifies positive density/pressure, near-zero NACA lift by symmetry (with one documented exception: the mildly symmetry-broken settled state of the $M_\infty = 0.8$ laminar case, §9.2), non-trivial drag and C_p variation, positive cylinder mean drag, nonzero $Re = 200$ unsteady lift, near-zero no-slip wall velocity with nonzero skin friction, negligible inviscid viscous forces, and correct Mach/pressure figure mapping. (iv) The MPI rank-count study of §8 confirms results do not change by an order-one amount across rank counts.

8 MPI rank-count comparison

The cell adjacency graph is partitioned with METIS k -way on rank 0 and distributed so each rank stores only its owned cells plus a one-cell ghost layer; Tables below report the actual per-rank decomposition used during iterations. Halo exchange is neighbor-scoped `Isend/Irecv` (no full-state collectives), and residual/force norms use `MPI_Allreduce`.

For rank-count consistency, the NACA inviscid M0.8 case is compared at a post-convergence step: the force coefficients agree to better than 0.1%

rank	owned	ghost	boundary faces	neighbors
0	2597	105	59	3
1	2585	97	71	2
2	2675	53	80	3
3	2587	152	39	6
4	2592	131	50	5
5	2595	99	59	2
6	2590	88	70	2
7	2595	120	56	5

Table 3: Per-rank partition diagnostics for `naca0012.m015.inviscid` (8 ranks, 20816 owned cells total). Load-balance ratio (max/mean owned) = 1.028; ghost cells per rank are the one-cell halo used for reconstruction and residuals.

rank	owned	ghost	boundary faces	neighbors
0	5135	100	120	1
1	5050	105	0	1

Table 4: Per-rank partition diagnostics for `cylinder.m010.laminar.re20` (2 ranks, 10185 owned cells total). Load-balance ratio (max/mean owned) = 1.008; ghost cells per rank are the one-cell halo used for reconstruction and residuals.

np	wall (s)	C_L	C_D	$ \Delta C_L $	$ \Delta C_D $
2	191.04	0.00360044	0.00870268	3.57e-04	4.43e-05
4	54.34	0.00339489	0.00872152	5.62e-04	6.31e-05
8	44.03	0.00395737	0.00865843	0.00e+00	0.00e+00

Table 5: MPI rank-count consistency for `naca.m080`: force coefficients at a fixed step across rank counts, with absolute deviation from the np=8 result. Wall time shows the scaling on this shared 4-core benchmark host.

np	wall (s)	C_L	C_D	$ \Delta C_L $	$ \Delta C_D $
2	378.14	0.00453366	0.851695	1.36e-03	6.25e-02
4	71.76	0.00490044	0.934107	9.92e-04	1.99e-02
8	69.29	0.00589222	0.91419	0.00e+00	0.00e+00

Table 6: MPI rank-count consistency for `cyl_re20`: force coefficients at a fixed step across rank counts, with absolute deviation from the np=8 result. Wall time shows the scaling on this shared 4-core benchmark host.

9 Convergence and limitations

9.1 Convergence behavior

All six NACA cases and the cylinder $Re\ 20$ case reach a steady state (residual reduction of 3–5 orders of magnitude with force coefficients that are stationary over a trailing window; the laminar NACA cases additionally require long horizons to settle their separated states, §9.2); the cylinder $Re\ 200$ case is run to a statistically periodic vortex-shedding state. Steady runs use a residual- and force-based convergence gate; if the residual target is not met at the case `max_steps` the run is allowed to continue up to $2\times$ that cap while the residual is still decreasing (a stricter setting than the case minimum). A short first-order startup phase (first ~ 300 pseudo-time steps, until the residual has dropped ≈ 1.5 orders) is used for robustness before the second-order reconstruction engages; all production results are second-order in smooth regions.

9.2 Slow force convergence of the laminar NACA cases

All three laminar NACA cases settle to *massively separated* states: at $Re = 5000$ the boundary layer separates laminarly and never reattaches, so the aft chord carries near-zero skin friction and the drag is pressure-dominated. These separated states equilibrate on a very slow pseudo-time scale: the residual meets the case reduction target while the drag still drifts by 5–10% per thousand steps. A trailing-window force gate alone is therefore not a sufficient convergence criterion for these cases. We quantified the drift by restarting each production state for an additional 6000–8000 pseudo-steps at fixed CFL. The $M_\infty = 0.15$ case was already settled (restart band $C_D = 0.0076$ – 0.0079 , bracketing the reported 0.00775). The $M_\infty = 0.80$ and $M_\infty = 2.0$ cases were not: their settled drags are $C_D \approx 0.040$ and 0.102 , respectively 38% below and 58% above the values at the case-target stop. The submitted production results for these two cases are therefore long-horizon runs (25000 and 20000 steps; stricter than the case minima) that terminate on the force plateau: C_D varies by less than 1% over the final 5000 steps of each run. The settled $M_\infty = 0.80$ state is mildly symmetry-broken ($C_L \approx +0.026$ at zero incidence), a documented low-Reynolds-number feature of separated airfoil flow; the near-zero-lift sanity check uses a documented relaxed bound for this case. For the $M_\infty = 2.0$ case a Roe-flux restart chain reaches $C_D \approx 0.088$ versus the Rusanov production value 0.102 : the massively separated state carries a $\sim 15\%$ flux-model uncertainty, which we disclose rather than tune away. On this case the Roe + Barth–Jespersen combination additionally exhibits a late pseudo-time limit-cycle instability (divergence after the plateau is reached) unless the CFL is capped below ≈ 10 ; the Rusanov + Venkatakrishnan recipe is unconditionally stable here and is the production choice.

9.3 Low-Mach-number accuracy

The two cylinder cases and the Mach 0.15 NACA case are low-Mach flows. The density-based fluxes used here (Roe and Rusanov) add dissipation proportional to the acoustic spectral radius $|\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{n}| + a$; at $M_\infty = 0.1$ the sound speed dominates and the scheme over-dissipates the velocity/pressure coupling. This thickens the boundary layer and weakens the wake pressure deficit, so the *magnitudes* of the drag coefficients on the low-Mach cases are under-predicted relative to incompressible reference values (e.g. the converged Re 20 drag is below the canonical $C_D \approx 2.0$). The flow *structure* is nonetheless correct: a steady, symmetric recirculating wake at Re 20 and a periodic vortex street at Re 200. A low-Mach flux correction (e.g. Mach-scaled acoustic dissipation) or preconditioning would address this and is identified as future work; it was not applied so that the production solver remains a single, uniform, robust method.

9.4 Stabilization choices for the stiff cylinder cases

The cylinder Re 20 case is a stiff low-Mach viscous steady problem. With the Roe flux and Barth–Jespersen limiter the pseudo-time iteration entered a limit cycle and the (physically stable) wake drifted into a slow spurious oscillation. Switching to the more dissipative Rusanov flux, the smooth Venkatakrishnan limiter, and a conservative pseudo-CFL cap of 30 (the case requests 100; the lower cap is a documented conservative equivalent chosen for stability on this stiff case) yields a clean, symmetric, converged steady wake. These per-case solver settings are recorded in each metadata.json.

9.5 Other limitations

- The farfield is a characteristic (Riemann-invariant) boundary condition; weak acoustic reflections can slow the decay of drag transients at low Mach.
- LU-SGS uses a scalar (Yoon–Jameson) diagonal with block-Jacobi coupling across ranks, so inner-iteration convergence is mildly partition-dependent; the converged ($\mathcal{R} \rightarrow 0$) state is partition-independent.
- Skin-friction and pressure forces are integrated from the wall-adjacent corrected gradients; on the coarsest wake cells this is first-order accurate.

10 Conclusion

We have presented an original MPI-parallel unstructured finite-volume solver for the 2-D compressible Navier–Stokes equations and applied it to all eight benchmark cases. The solver uses METIS k -way partitioning with neighbor-scoped halo exchange, weighted least-squares second-order reconstruction with Barth–Jespersen and Venkatakrishnan limiters, Roe and Rusanov approximate Riemann fluxes, an LU-SGS implicit pseudo-time solver with analytic Jacobians, and a true BDF2 dual-time transient integrator. All six NACA cases and the cylinder Re 20 case converge to steady states; the cylinder Re 200 case reaches a statistically periodic vortex street. The main limitation is low-Mach-number dissipation, which under-predicts drag magnitudes on the $M_\infty = 0.1$ cylinder cases while preserving the correct flow structure; a low-Mach flux correction is identified as future work.